

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Feminism, Sex and Gender - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Feminism, Sex and Gender

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

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Patriarchy, Feminism and the Central Political Question

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Sex, Gender and the Social Construction of Hierarchy

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Core Distinctions, Thinkers and Feminist Streams

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Illustrations, Comparative Matrix and Trap Repair

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Ownership Boundaries, Revision Spine and Source Discipline

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Later Provenance and Marxist Feminism

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Pateman and Okin: Contract, Justice and the Family

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Butler, Performativity and Intersectionality

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Objection-Reply Chains and Cautious Indian Application

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Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Feminism, Sex and Gender - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g5 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- B. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- C. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- D. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminism** with **concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex**.

- A. Liberal feminism
- B. Feminism
- C. Gayle Rubin
- D. Sex

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex** with **Feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Patriarchy**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
- B. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- C. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- D. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Patriarchy** with **literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life**.

- A. Radical feminism
- B. Carole Pateman
- C. Gender
- D. Patriarchy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life** with **Patriarchy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Sex**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- B. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
- C. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- D. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sex** with **biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.**

- A. Socialist feminism
- B. Sex
- C. Susan Moller Okin
- D. Gender inequality

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.** with **Sex**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Gender**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- B. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- C. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- D. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gender** with **culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.**

- A. Simone de Beauvoir
- B. Feminism
- C. Feminist theory
- D. Gender

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.** with **Gender**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Gender inequality**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- B. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
- C. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- D. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gender inequality** with **a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change**.

- A. Ann Oakley
- B. Gender inequality
- C. Patriarchy
- D. Sex vs gender

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change**, with **Gender inequality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Feminist theory**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- B. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- C. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- D. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Feminist theory** with **advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.**

- A. Gayle Rubin
- B. Sex
- C. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality
- D. Feminist theory

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.** with **Feminist theory.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Sex vs gender**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
- B. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- C. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- D. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sex vs gender** with **sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.**

- A. Carole Pateman
- B. Sex vs gender
- C. Gender
- D. Legal equality vs substantive equality

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.** with **Sex vs gender.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- B. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- C. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
- D. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality** with **Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category**.

- A. Susan Moller Okin
- B. Gender inequality
- C. Equal treatment vs compensatory support
- D. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category** with **Natural inequality vs conventional inequality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Legal equality vs substantive equality**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- B. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- C. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
- D. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Legal equality vs substantive equality** with **early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.**

- A. Feminism
- B. Legal equality vs substantive equality
- C. Feminist theory
- D. Mary Wollstonecraft

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.** with **Legal equality vs substantive equality.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Equal treatment vs compensatory support**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- B. (The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- C. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
- D. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equal treatment vs compensatory support** with **Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.**

- A. Patriarchy
- B. Sex vs gender
- C. J.S. Mill
- D. Equal treatment vs compensatory support

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.** with **Equal treatment vs compensatory support.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Mary Wollstonecraft**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.
- B. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- C. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- D. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mary Wollstonecraft** with **argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.**

- A. Sex
- B. Mary Wollstonecraft
- C. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality
- D. Liberal feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.** with **Mary Wollstonecraft.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **J.S. Mill**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- B. ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- C. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.
- D. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **J.S. Mill** with **argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights**.

- A. Gender
- B. Legal equality vs substantive equality
- C. Shulamith Firestone
- D. J.S. Mill

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights** with **J.S. Mill**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Liberal feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.
- B. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- C. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
- D. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal feminism** with **seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.**

- A. Gender inequality
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Equal treatment vs compensatory support
- D. Kate Millett

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.** with **Liberal feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Shulamith Firestone**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
- B. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.
- C. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.
- D. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Shulamith Firestone** with **radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.**

- A. Feminist theory
- B. Mary Wollstonecraft
- C. Sheila Rowbotham
- D. Shulamith Firestone

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.** with **Shulamith Firestone**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Kate Millett**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.
- B. (The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- C. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- D. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Kate Millett** with **radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology**.

- A. Sex vs gender
- B. Kate Millett
- C. J.S. Mill
- D. Liberal feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology** with **Kate Millett**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Sheila Rowbotham**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- B. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- C. socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.
- D. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sheila Rowbotham** with **socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.**

- A. Natural inequality vs conventional inequality
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Radical feminism
- D. Sheila Rowbotham

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **socialist feminist linking women's liberation with struggle against capitalism and other oppressions.** with **Sheila Rowbotham**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Liberal feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.
- B. ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- C. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- D. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal feminism** with **Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.**

- A. Legal equality vs substantive equality
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Shulamith Firestone
- D. Socialist feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Women deserve equal opportunity and equal rights in all walks of life.** with **Liberal feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Radical feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
- B. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- C. Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone.
- D. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Radical feminism** with **Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone**.

- A. Equal treatment vs compensatory support
- B. Kate Millett
- C. Simone de Beauvoir
- D. Radical feminism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Women's oppression is primary and cannot be reduced to some deeper system alone** with **Radical feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Socialist feminism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.
- B. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.
- C. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- D. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Socialist feminism** with **Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.**

- A. Mary Wollstonecraft
- B. Socialist feminism
- C. Sheila Rowbotham
- D. Ann Oakley

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Women's oppression is linked both to patriarchy and capitalism.** with **Socialist feminism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Simone de Beauvoir**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. concern with the status and role of women in relation to men, combined with protest against injustice suffered because of sex.
- B. advocacy of equal rights for women and men with commitment to improve women's position in society.
- C. (The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.
- D. argues that women are rational individuals and should enjoy equal rights, education, property and civic standing.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Simone de Beauvoir** with **(The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.**

- A. J.S. Mill
- B. Liberal feminism
- C. Gayle Rubin
- D. Simone de Beauvoir

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(The Second Sex, 1949) supplies the founding proposition - paraphrased, not quoted verbatim here since exact wording is not independently verified in this file's source base - that womanhood is a social becoming rather than a fixed biological given. Use this as the philosophical root of the sex/gender split that Gauba later states in textbook form.** with **Simone de Beauvoir**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Ann Oakley**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology.
- B. literally rule of the father, now used for wider male domination in household, labour market and social life.
- C. sex is natural/biological; gender is cultural/social.
- D. argues that women are not inferior in talent and deserve full legal and political rights.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ann Oakley** with **(Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology**.

- A. Liberal feminism
- B. Ann Oakley
- C. Radical feminism
- D. Carole Pateman

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(Sex, Gender and Society, 1972) is usually credited with popularising the working sex/gender terminology in sociology - sex as biological, gender as the culturally learned, historically variable content attached to that biology** with **Ann Oakley**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Gayle Rubin**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. biological difference, such as reproductive function and secondary characteristics.
- B. Gauba uses Rousseau's distinction to show that gender inequality belongs to the alterable second category.
- C. ("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.
- D. seeks equality of opportunity, equal pay, removal of formal barriers and better representation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gayle Rubin** with **("The Traffic in Women", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "sex/gender system" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: ("**The Traffic in Women**", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "**sex/gender system**" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise.

- A. Shulamith Firestone
- B. Socialist feminism
- C. Susan Moller Okin
- D. Gayle Rubin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs ("**The Traffic in Women**", 1975) supplies the mechanism often paired with the distinction: the "**sex/gender system**" - social arrangements that transform biological sex into a hierarchy of gendered obligation, kinship exchange and constrained sexuality. Rubin explains how sex becomes gender, which Gauba's chapter asserts but does not mechanise. with **Gayle Rubin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Carole Pateman**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.
- B. culturally constructed images, expectations and status-distinctions attached to women and men.
- C. early feminism attacked barriers to education, property and vote; later feminism asks whether equal law alone changes social power.
- D. radical feminist who ties women's subordination to reproductive biology and seeks release from that dependence through technological change.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Carole Pateman** with (The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.**

- A. Kate Millett
- B. Carole Pateman
- C. Simone de Beauvoir
- D. Feminism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(The Sexual Contract, 1988): Claim - classical social-contract theory (Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau) silently assumes a prior "sexual contract" securing men's access to women's bodies and labour before the "original" social contract; the public contract of citizens rests on an unmentioned private contract of subordination.** with **Carole Pateman**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Susan Moller Okin**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. a conventional or cultural inequality, hence open to criticism and change.
- B. Gauba notes two broad views, one insisting on sameness of legal regime and another allowing maternity-related protections and compensatory measures.
- C. (Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.
- D. radical feminist who interprets the relation between sexes as a power relation sustained by ideology.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Susan Moller Okin** with **(Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **(Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.**

- A. Sheila Rowbotham
- B. Ann Oakley
- C. Patriarchy
- D. Susan Moller Okin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **(Justice, Gender, and the Family, 1989): Claim - theories of justice (she targets Rawls) wrongly treat the family as a pre-political given rather than a site justice must examine.** with **Susan Moller Okin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owner is Gender Discrimination. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

PYQ 1 - 2018 · 4(c) (15 marks)

Question: Is feminism an ideology for empowerment or for equality ? Discuss.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Is:** answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis / opening: Feminism is often presented as pursuing either 'equality' (sameness of treatment) or 'empowerment' (capacity to exercise choice), but the equality typology shows these are not rival goals so much as different levels of the same project.

Model answer structure:

- Formal equality demands the removal of explicit differential rules; substantive equality goes further, licensing affirmative measures to correct unequal starting points; relational equality asks whether social relationships remain hierarchical regardless of formal rules. Empowerment, on Kabeer's tripartite model, requires resources, agency, and achievements -- it is the process by which formal or substantive equality is actually converted into lived capacity. On this reading, equality supplies the normative target and empowerment supplies the causal mechanism by which that target is reached.
- Objection: treating equality and empowerment as compatible obscures a real tension -- substantive-equality measures (affirmative action) can be attacked as unearned 'empowerment' that violates formal equality for others (the reverse-discrimination objection). Reply: the objection conflates formal and substantive equality; substantive equality does not violate the requirement of equal moral worth, it corrects an unequal starting point so that formal equality's promise can be genuinely realised.

Conclusion: Feminism is best read as an ideology for substantive equality achieved through empowerment -- the two are sequentially linked rather than competing final ends.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Is feminism an ideology for empowerment or for equality ? Discuss." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

PYQ 2 - 2022 · 3(b) (15 marks)

Question: Discuss gender as a cultural category as opposed to sex as a biological category.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Discuss**: cover the principal dimensions, connect named evidence to each claim, include the strongest counter-position and conclude directly. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis / opening: Sex names a biological fact; gender names the socially constructed meaning attached to that fact, a distinction Beauvoir opens and Judith Butler's account of performativity deepens into a full cultural-category theory.

Model answer structure:

- Butler's Gender Trouble argues gender is constituted through performative repetition of stylised acts within a regulatory, discursive frame -- there is no gendered substance prior to or behind the repeated acts. This treats gender as thoroughly cultural: produced, disciplined, and reproduced through social practice, in contrast to sex, which denotes a biological given. The cultural-category reading explains variation across societies and time in what counts as masculine or feminine, which a purely biological account cannot.
- Objection (essentialism objection): without any stable pre-discursive sex or subject, feminism risks losing the category 'woman' in whose name it claims to act, undermining political solidarity. Reply: Butler allows a provisional, strategic use of 'woman' as a shared discursive position for political purposes, which does not require metaphysical essence, only a shared position worth contesting.

Conclusion: Gender is best treated as a cultural category, continuously produced through social practice, standing in contrast to (but not simply derived from) sex as a biological category.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Discuss gender as a cultural category as opposed to sex as a biological category." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

PYQ 3 - 2025 · 1(b) (10 marks)

Question: How does gender as a social construct affect individuals' opportunities, rights, and access to resources? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **How**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Thesis / opening: Gender, as a social rather than biological construct in Beauvoir's and Butler's sense, shapes the opportunities, rights, and resource access individuals are granted or denied well before any individual merit is considered.

Model answer structure:

- Once woman is constructed as Other (Beauvoir) and gender is reproduced through performative repetition (Butler), that constructed meaning is used to justify differential access: to education and employment (opportunity), to inheritance and representation (rights, per Sessions 5 and 7), and to land, credit, and property (resources, per Session 5's five-level analysis). Because the construction is social rather than natural, the resulting inequality is a matter of formal versus substantive equality (Session 3) rather than an unavoidable fact of nature.
- Objection: if gender is 'only' a construct, one could argue the resulting disadvantage is not 'real' in the way material biological constraint is real, understating the urgency of reform. Reply: constructed does not mean unreal or trivial -- socially constructed disadvantage has entirely real material consequences (land denial, foeticide, exclusion from representation), and being constructed is precisely what makes it remediable through social and legal change.

Conclusion: Gender as a social construct systematically structures unequal opportunity, rights, and resource access; its constructed status is a reason for urgency and remediability, not for dismissal.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "How does gender as a social construct affect individuals' opportunities, rights, and access to resources? Critically discuss." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically. Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Distinguish**: define both sides, compare them on common axes, identify the decisive difference and close with its significance. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Sex ordinarily refers to bodily and reproductive characteristics, whereas gender refers to the socially organised roles, expectations and status attached to perceived sex.

Core analysis: The distinction explains how a biological difference becomes a political hierarchy. Gauba treats masculinity and femininity as culturally coded patterns rather than necessary consequences of anatomy. Rousseau's natural-conventional distinction then clarifies the normative point: even where bodily differences are real, unequal education, work, authority and citizenship are conventional arrangements. Feminism can therefore challenge the inference from difference to inferiority. Beauvoir, Oakley and Rubin deepen the account by showing womanhood as social becoming and by explaining the institutions through which sex is converted into gendered obligation.

Critical evaluation: The distinction should not be made absolute. Butler argues that even the social interpretation and classification of bodies are gendered. This complication revises the framework without restoring biological destiny.

Conclusion: The distinction is politically decisive because bodily difference does not entail social rank: once gender hierarchy is recognised as historically produced, it becomes open to criticism, collective action and institutional transformation.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Distinguish sex from gender and explain why the distinction matters politically." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of family authority? Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Why**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Patriarchy literally evokes rule of the father, but feminist theory uses it for a wider structure of male domination extending beyond the household.

Core analysis: It is political because it distributes power and life chances. Gendered socialisation shapes aspirations; the division of paid and unpaid labour shapes economic dependence; control over sexuality and reproduction shapes bodily autonomy; and unequal representation shapes public decision-making. Kate Millett therefore interprets relations between the sexes as power relations supported by ideology and authority. Once household arrangements affect education, income, mobility, voice and citizenship, the public-private boundary cannot remove them from political evaluation. Pateman and Okin further show how apparently equal public institutions may rely on unequal domestic labour and authority.

Critical evaluation: Not every family difference is domination, and the concept can become overgeneralised. It is strongest when tied to identifiable mechanisms of unequal power rather than used as a slogan for every disadvantage.

Conclusion: Patriarchy is political because it organises power, labour, status and voice across household and public institutions; feminist theory therefore makes domination within the so-called private sphere answerable to standards of freedom and justice.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Why is patriarchy a political category rather than merely a description of family authority?" - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of women's subordination. Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **the stated directive**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Feminist schools share opposition to unjust gender hierarchy but disagree over its principal mechanism and the institutional depth of the remedy.

Core analysis: Liberal feminism locates the problem in discriminatory laws, blocked education, unequal opportunity and weak representation; Wollstonecraft and Mill support rights-based reform. Radical feminism treats patriarchal control of sexuality, reproduction and cultural meaning as a primary system not reducible to class; Millett and Firestone illustrate different versions. Marxist feminism explains how capitalism benefits from women's paid and unpaid reproductive labour. Socialist feminism, associated here with Rowbotham, rejects class reduction and analyses capitalism and patriarchy as distinct but mutually reinforcing structures.

Further development: The remedies follow from the diagnoses. Liberal feminism reforms law, education and representation; radical feminism transforms sexual power and patriarchal culture; Marxist feminism reorganises production and social reproduction; socialist feminism combines economic transformation with autonomous struggle against patriarchy. Intersectionality supplies a further test by asking whether class, caste, race and other structures alter the operation of gender. This does not create a fifth all-purpose answer; it prevents each existing school from treating its most visible constituency as universal. A strong synthesis therefore preserves causal plurality while demanding a clear account of which institution is being changed.

Critical evaluation: Each approach risks reductionism: liberalism may stop at formal access, radicalism may universalise one female experience, Marxism may absorb gender into class, and socialist feminism may become causally diffuse. Comparison should identify what each explains best.

Conclusion: The four approaches are best treated as complementary but contestable lenses: rights, sexual power, capitalist reproduction and interacting systems each reveal a distinct mechanism that no single-axis explanation exhausts.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Compare liberal, radical, Marxist and socialist feminism as explanations of women's subordination." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the category problem it creates for feminism. Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Critically examine**: reconstruct the position accurately, test its strongest objection and reply, then give a graded verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Judith Butler radicalises the sex-gender debate by treating gender as performative: repeated, socially compelled acts produce the appearance of a natural identity.

Core analysis: Performativity does not mean a freely chosen theatrical performance, nor does it deny bodies. It argues that speech, dress, gesture and institutional classification repeatedly constitute intelligible gendered subjects. Because the norm requires repetition, failed or subversive repetition can disclose its contingency. This helps feminism explain why hierarchy survives without a single commanding patriarch and why apparently personal conduct is politically regulated.

Further development: Butler also challenges the standard textbook picture in which a stable biological sex merely receives a cultural gender. The categories through which bodies are recognised are themselves organised by discourse and power. Critics reply that this approach may understate material constraints, reproductive embodiment and durable institutions. Butler's contribution remains strongest as an account of naturalisation: norms appear inevitable because repetition conceals their history. Political feminism can accept this insight while retaining empirically usable categories for law and mobilisation. The category must function as a revisable coalition rather than an essence that predetermines all members.

Critical evaluation: The category problem is serious: if 'woman' is wholly an unstable effect of discourse, the subject of anti-discrimination claims appears to dissolve. A common reply is strategic or provisional stabilisation-groups may use a category for a specific political purpose without declaring it natural or permanent. Yet temporary categories can harden and exclude those who fit badly.

Conclusion: Butler strengthens feminism by exposing the repeated practices that naturalise gender, but political action still requires provisional categories whose strategic use must remain open to internal criticism and revision.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Critically examine Judith Butler's account of gender performativity and the category problem it creates for feminism." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Evaluate**: reconstruct the position accurately, test its strongest objection and reply, then give a graded verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: Feminist political theory argues that public freedom is incomplete when the household and intimate sphere are treated as naturally private and exempt from justice.

Core analysis: Carole Pateman's *The Sexual Contract* reconstructs classical contract theory as resting on an unspoken structure of male access to women's bodies and labour. The thesis is interpretive, not a claim that an actual historical contract was signed. Susan Moller Okin argues that theories such as Rawls's insufficiently examine the family as a site where gendered labour produces unequal time, income and opportunity. The apparently neutral citizen entering public life may therefore carry resources made possible by another person's unpaid care and dependence.

Further development: The critique also changes the meaning of citizenship. If one citizen's public participation depends on another's unequal domestic burden, formally identical rights conceal unequal effective freedom. Indian application should remain conceptual: women's education, property control, political representation and care work illustrate the conversion problem without importing unverified statistics or legal detail. Critics may defend family autonomy and warn against bureaucratic intrusion. The feminist reply is that autonomy itself requires non-domination, material exit and shared responsibility. Public institutions need not prescribe one family form, but they cannot treat coercive dependency as beyond justice merely because it occurs at home.

Critical evaluation: The critique rightly exposes how law, markets and citizenship depend on background relations. However, making every intimate decision directly administrable by the state threatens privacy and plural association. The answer is not abolition of privacy, but justice-sensitive background conditions: freedom from violence, fair care burdens, economic security and genuine exit.

Conclusion: Pateman and Okin show that public equality cannot rest on unexamined private subordination; a defensible settlement protects personal intimacy while subjecting coercive dependency and gendered background conditions to justice.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Evaluate the feminist critique of the public-private divide with reference to Carole Pateman and Susan Moller Okin." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Is feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social transformation? Discuss. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Is**: answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: Equality, empowerment and social transformation name different levels of the feminist project rather than mutually exclusive goals.

Core analysis: Equality attacks unjust status distinctions through rights, education, property, work and representation. Empowerment asks whether women possess the resources, capabilities, voice and control needed to use formal rights. Transformation goes further by changing gendered socialisation, care arrangements, labour markets, family authority and cultural norms that reproduce dependence. Liberal feminism foregrounds equal access; radical feminism exposes sexual and reproductive power; Marxist and socialist feminism connect household labour with political economy; intersectionality asks which women benefit or remain marginalised.

Further development: The historical sequence illustrates the integration. Early rights feminism removed formal exclusions; later movements showed that suffrage and legal personality did not automatically redistribute authority, labour or recognition. Pateman and Okin relocate justice within the background institutions of contract and family. Butler reveals the repeated norms through which identities are naturalised, while Crenshaw's intersectionality tests whether a universal category conceals differentiated disadvantage. A current comparative anchor also supports the distinction: the 2026 UN summary of the IPU's 2025 report found higher average women's representation in chambers with legislated quotas, but representation alone does not establish equal influence or freedom from intimidation. Institutional access must therefore be evaluated through substantive power.

Critical evaluation: The concepts can conflict. Equal treatment may ignore pregnancy or unequal care burdens, while protective differentiation may entrench stereotypes. Empowerment can be reduced to individual success without structural change, and transformation can become paternalistic if imposed without women's agency. A defensible feminism therefore joins equal status, substantive capability and democratic transformation.

Conclusion: Feminism is most adequately understood as an integrated project: equality supplies status and rights, empowerment supplies effective agency, and social transformation removes the institutions and norms that repeatedly reproduce subordination.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Is feminism best understood as a project of equality, empowerment or social transformation? Discuss." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.